
The Live Deal Prompt Pack

The 10 AI prompts I actually use before I reach out to anyone.

JULIE JAMES · 25 years in sales · still carrying a number

Why these are different

I have been in sales 25 years. The last 12 I have built and kept my own book of business, and I am still carrying a number today. Which means I am not teaching from memory.

These are not prompts I wrote for a piece of content. They are the ones open on my second monitor while I work a real list.

I cold call. Every day. Still. That matters here for one reason only: a cold call is the least forgiving place research can land. No delete key, no second draft, no time to think of a better way to say it. If what you found holds up in the first eight seconds of a phone call, it holds up in an email, a DM, or a follow up.

You do not need to cold call to use any of this. Not one prompt in here assumes you pick up a phone. The research is the same work whether you call, email, DM, or answer an inbound form. The channel is the last decision you make, not the first.

Everything in Part 1 is industry agnostic. I have sold in more than one industry and the fundamentals carried over every time, so point these at whatever vertical you sell into.

How to use this

Fill in anything in **[brackets]**. Run Part 1 top to bottom the first time so you see how the outputs stack. After that you will know which three you actually need for a given account.

Two rules that make the difference between useful output and impressive-sounding garbage:

1. **Make it cite sources.** If it cannot tell you where a claim came from, treat the claim as invented. I ask for links on anything I plan to say out loud.
2. **Make it tell you what it does not know.** A prompt that ends with "list what you could not verify" saves you from confidently repeating something wrong to a stranger.

Budget: about 10 minutes per account for the first four prompts. That is the whole point. Research used to take me an afternoon.

Part 1: The research

This is the heart of the pack. Everything else is deployment.

1. Industry primer

Use it when: you are opening a new vertical, or a list drops in your lap and you cannot explain how these companies stay in business.

I sell [what you sell] to [type of company] in the [industry] industry.

Explain this industry to me like I have to hold a conversation with an operator in it tomorrow. Cover:

1. How companies in this industry actually make money, including where the margin sits and where it leaks
2. The 3 to 5 metrics operators here are judged on
3. What is under pressure in this industry right now, and why
4. The vocabulary an insider uses that an outsider gets wrong
5. Who else is already selling into these companies

Cite sources with links for anything time sensitive.

End with a list of what you could not verify.

Good output looks like: you can name the pressure they are under before they tell you. Bad output reads like a Wikipedia summary and uses the word "landscape."

2. How this specific company makes money

Use it when: before every single first touch. This is the one I skip least.

Company: [company], [website]

Tell me how this specific business makes money. Not the industry, this company. Cover:

1. What they sell, to whom, and how they charge for it
2. Who their customers appear to be, based on their own site, case studies, and job postings
3. How they are positioned against competitors, in their own words
4. What their hiring tells me about where they are investing
5. Anything that suggests they are growing, shrinking, or holding

Use their own language where you can. Cite sources.

Flag anything you are inferring rather than reading.

Good output looks like: a paragraph you could say back to them that would make them think you already work there. If it just restates their homepage headline, push it again and ask what the job postings say.

3. The reason to reach out today

Use it when: you have a name and a company and no particular reason to call this week rather than next quarter. This prompt finds the reason.

Company: [company]

Find me a reason to reach out to this company this week.

Search the last 6 months for:

- Funding, acquisition, or new investment
- Leadership hires or departures, especially in [relevant function]
- New locations, new products, new markets, or closures
- Regulatory or supply changes hitting their category
- Awards, press, conference appearances, published interviews
- Job postings that imply a project or a gap

For each item: what happened, the date, the source link, and one sentence on why someone in my position would care.

Rank them by how likely they are to create real urgency.

If there is nothing genuinely notable, say so plainly.

Good output looks like: two or three dated items with links. The "say so plainly" line matters. An account with no trigger is useful information, not a failure. It tells you to send an email instead of spending a dial on it.

4. The person, and what they are actually measured on

Use it when: you know who you are reaching out to and want to stop guessing what they care about.

Person: [name], [title] at [company]

Anything I already know: [paste LinkedIn, bio, or notes]

Help me understand this person's job. Cover:

1. What someone in this role at a company this size actually does day to day
2. What they are measured on, and who measures them
3. What is probably making their job harder right now, given what is happening at this company and in this industry
4. What they likely do not control, so I stop pitching things that are not their decision
5. Their likely path here and where they probably want to go next

Separate what you found from what you are inferring.

Good output looks like: a clear read on what would make this person look good to their boss. Point 4 is the one that saves calls. Pitching a director on something only the CFO signs off is how you get a polite no that goes nowhere.

5. The gap

Use it when: you have run prompts 2 through 4 and want the one observation nobody else in their inbox has made. This is the prompt that separates research from homework.

Here is what I know about [company]:

[paste the output from prompts 2, 3, and 4]

Find the gaps. Specifically:

- Where does what they say publicly not match what they appear to be doing?
- What are they clearly investing in that they are not talking about, or talking about but not resourcing?
- What would someone inside this company be frustrated about that an outsider would not notice?

Give me 3 observations. For each, tell me the evidence and how confident you are. Do not manufacture a gap if there is not one. Say "nothing solid here" instead.

Good output looks like: something you could open with that would make them pause. "You have been hiring [role] for four months and still have the req open" beats anything you can say about your own company.

6. Build the opener

Use it when: you have the research and now need the first line. Works spoken or written, which is deliberate.

Write me an opening line for a first contact with [name],
[title] at [company].

Context I have: [paste your best 2 findings]

What I sell: [one plain sentence, no jargon]

Rules:

- Under 25 words
- It must work spoken out loud and typed. Read it aloud before you give it to me. If it has clauses I would not say to a person, rewrite it.
- No compliments about their company
- No "I noticed" or "I came across"
- No question I already know the answer to
- It should earn 30 more seconds, not close a deal

Give me 3 versions with different angles. Then tell me which one you would use and why.

Good output looks like: something you would actually say. The read-it-aloud rule is not decoration. It is what stops the AI from handing you a sentence with three subordinate clauses that no human has ever spoken.

7. Pressure test it

Use it when: right after prompt 6, before you use the opener on anyone who matters.

Here is my opener: [paste]

Here is who it is going to: [name, title, company]

Play the prospect. You are busy, slightly annoyed, and you get a lot of these.

1. What is your honest first reaction?
2. What is the "so what" you are thinking but not saying?
3. On a scale of 1 to 10, how likely are you to give me another 30 seconds, and what would move it up 2 points?
4. Rewrite it as the version you would actually respond to.

Be harsh. A soft answer here costs me a real conversation later.

Good output looks like: something that stings a little. If the AI tells you your opener is great, tell it to try again and be harsher. This prompt has killed more of my openers than anything else, which is exactly what it is for.

8. Anticipate the brush off

Use it when: before the conversation, not after. Prepare for three, not fifteen.

I sell [what you sell] to [role] at [type of company]
in [industry].

Give me the 3 most likely brush offs I will get, ranked by
how often they actually happen in this industry. Not generic
objections. The specific ones this audience uses.

For each one:

1. What they are really saying underneath it
2. A response under 20 words that keeps the conversation open
3. What NOT to say, and why it makes it worse
4. How to tell the difference between a real objection and
a reflex to get off the phone

The response has to sound like a person, not a script.

Good output looks like: responses short enough to remember without reading. If you need to read it, you will sound like you are reading it. Three is the right number. Nobody has ever handled fifteen prepared objections in a live conversation.

9. Follow up that does not sound like a template

Use it when: after any first touch that did not end in a clear no. This is where most people lose deals, by going quiet or by sending "just checking in."

I reached out to [name] at [company] on [date].
What happened: [no response / short reply / good call / they went dark after showing interest]
What we actually discussed: [paste your notes]

Write my follow up.

Rules:

- Reference something specific from the interaction, or from research, that proves I was paying attention
- Add something they did not have before. A link, a number, a relevant example. If I have nothing to add, tell me that and tell me to wait instead
- Never "just checking in," "circling back," "bumping this," or "wanted to see if you had thoughts"
- Under 80 words
- End with something easy to answer, not a request for 30 minutes

Also tell me how long I should wait before sending it.

Good output looks like: a message that would be worth sending even if you were not trying to sell anything. The "tell me to wait instead" clause is the important one. Following up with nothing new is how you teach someone to ignore you.

10. Reactivate a dormant account

Use it when: the list you already have is almost always better than the list you are about to buy. I run this quarterly on old accounts.

I last spoke with [name] at [company] around [date].

Here is what happened: [paste notes, or describe it]

Why it stalled: [budget / timing / champion left / no reason given / I dropped the ball]

Two things:

1. Search for what has changed at this company since then.

New leadership, funding, growth, restructuring, anything that would change the answer they gave me.

2. Based on what actually changed, write a reopener under 60 words. It should acknowledge the gap honestly without apologizing for it, and lead with what is different now, not with me.

If nothing has changed that would change their answer, say so and tell me to leave it alone for another quarter.

Good output looks like: a reason that belongs to them, not to you. "Saw you brought on a new [role]" is a reason. "Wanted to reconnect" is not. And an honest "leave it alone" saves you from burning a relationship you might need in six months.

Part 2: Same research, different channel

The research above does not change. How you deliver it does. Here is what shifts.

Cold call

This is my channel. Spoken, live, no editing.

Your opener has to land in one sentence and survive being interrupted. Read it out loud before you dial. If you stumble on it, it is written, not spoken, and they will hear that instantly.

Take one finding into the call. Not three. You will not get to three.

Add to prompt 6: `This will be spoken on a live phone call. Strip every clause I would not say out loud. Under 20 words.`

Cold email

Scannable, and the subject line is doing most of the work.

Your best research finding goes in the subject line or the first line, not paragraph three. Nobody reaches paragraph three.

Add to prompt 6: `Give me 3 subject lines under 6 words, each built on a specific research finding, no clickbait and no false familiarity. Then a first line under 20 words that pays off whichever subject line I pick.`

Social and DM

Shorter than email, and context is visible. They can see who you are before they decide, which cuts both ways.

Skip the pitch entirely on first contact. Reference something real and let it be a conversation.

Add to prompt 6: This is a DM. Under 40 words, no pitch, no link, no ask for a meeting. Just the observation and an open question.

Note: I do not run cold social outreach myself. Included because the research transfers cleanly and plenty of people sell this way.

Inbound follow up

They raised their hand. Different game, and speed beats polish.

Do the research anyway. Do it faster. The one thing you must know before you respond is what they were looking at and what problem sent them looking.

Add to prompt 4: This is an inbound lead who filled out [form / requested a demo / downloaded X]. Given that, what problem were they most likely trying to solve when they did it?

Warm referral

The referral gets you the meeting. It does not get you the deal, and it does not excuse skipping the work.

Lead with the referrer, then immediately prove you did your homework anyway. Coasting on the introduction is the fastest way to waste one.

Add to prompt 6: I was referred by [name], who [relationship to them]. Open with the referral in the first 10 words, then move straight to a specific observation about their business. Do not spend two sentences on the introduction.

One last thing

If you want the rest of what I am testing, including the prompts that did not make this pack and the ones I am still fixing, it goes out in the newsletter. Free, short, and written between calls.

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